

Chips Carry It

S&P 500 +0.80% and Nasdaq +1.30% as a broad semiconductor bid absorbed overnight U.S.–Iran strikes and oil eased. VIX –6.27%. Growth Portfolio +2.09%, ahead of IUSG.

THE SESSION

The tape resolved the morning’s open question decisively in favor of the semiconductor complex. After Wednesday’s split session and an overnight escalation that saw the U.S. strike Iranian targets and Iran retaliate against U.S.-allied bases in the Gulf, equities opened cautious and then turned higher and stayed there. The S&P 500 closed +0.80% at 7,542, the Nasdaq +1.30% at 26,207, and the Dow +0.27%. The VIX fell 6.27% to 15.84 — the clearest tell that the market chose to read the Middle East as an energy-and-defense premium rather than a broad risk-off.

The catalyst was chips, and the catalyst behind chips was capacity. Micron announced a fresh U.S. investment as part of a decade-long buildout it now frames at more than \$250 billion, and SK Hynix’s U.S. listing — which debuts Friday — was reported to be roughly seven times oversubscribed. That combination reframed the week’s chip volatility as demand, not fragility. Lam Research led our book with a 6.01% gain; AMD added 5.67%, Marvell 4.99%, and the rest of the semiconductor sleeve moved with it. The move was broad enough to lift the Growth Portfolio 2.09% on the day.

Underneath the index prints, the composition rotated cleanly. Oil eased as the President signaled an opening for negotiation, and the energy premium that carried Wednesday reversed — Devon fell 2.98%, ONEOK 1.82%, Chevron 1.09%, and Valero gave back 0.58%. Financials repaired, with Synchrony recovering 4.85% of Wednesday’s concentrated give-back. Copper and gold miners participated as gold rose 1.43%: Freeport gained 5.27% and Agnico Eagle 2.86%.

IOWN Tactical: The S&P sits comfortably above its 200-day and well clear of any drawdown tranche. Nothing in today’s action changes the posture — this is a session to observe, not to transact. Our discipline reads geopolitical noise for what it does to the businesses we own, and today it did very little.

FCI HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

MARA +9.98% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Bitcoin miners bid as BTC firmed to roughly \$63,195 (+1.54%); the leader of our miner sleeve on the day.

LRCX +6.01% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Lam Research led the semiconductor-equipment surge tied to Micron’s expanded U.S. capacity plan and broad chip demand.

AMD +5.67% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Rode the AI-chip bid alongside a semiconductor gauge that climbed roughly 4% on the session.

FCX +5.27% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Freeport tracked a firmer copper and metals complex as gold rose 1.43%.

MRVL +4.99% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Marvell joined the communications-chip leadership cited across the tape.

SYF +4.85% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Synchrony recovered the bulk of Wednesday’s concentrated give-back as financials repaired.

FTNT +4.48% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Fortinet extended the cyber bid alongside broad tech strength.

AEM +2.86% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Agnico Eagle firmed with gold’s advance to \$4,141.

QCOM +2.44% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Qualcomm participated in the chip rally; a rare semiconductor name in the dividend sleeve.

IBIT +1.65% DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Spot-Bitcoin ETF tracked BTC higher as the digital sleeve reset from Wednesday.

DECLINERS

NTR –3.28% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Nutrien eased with the agricultural and materials complex.

DVN –2.98% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Devon gave back Wednesday’s energy premium as oil fell on diplomacy signals.

STLD –2.93% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Steel Dynamics softened as cyclical took a back seat to the chip bid.

CL –2.18% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Colgate slipped with staples as PepsiCo’s mixed print set a cautious read-across.

LMT –1.84% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Lockheed continued its defense give-back as the Iran premium faded on negotiation hopes.

OKE -1.82%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

ONEOK tracked the softer energy tape.

CVX -1.09%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Chevron eased with crude.

NVDA -0.66%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Nvidia was a modest laggard within a broadly higher chip complex — rotation, not weakness.

HOLDINGS NEWS

Semiconductor capacity, not the ceasefire, set the sleeve's tone. Micron's expanded U.S. investment — framed as part of a plan exceeding \$250 billion over the decade — and SK Hynix's heavily oversubscribed U.S. debut (listing Friday) supplied the demand narrative that lifted Lam Research, AMD, Marvell, Analog Devices, NXP, Credo, and Qualcomm across both sleeves.

PepsiCo unofficially opened earnings season. Not a holding, but its mixed print and roughly 3% dip framed a cautious read-across for our staples names — Colgate and Church & Dwight both eased. Q2 reporting broadens next week, when the businesses we own begin to speak for themselves.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY

✓ BEAT DVY

+0.22%

vs. DVY -0.03% | SPY +0.84%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO

✓ BEAT

+2.09%

vs. IUSG +1.13%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +16.52% vs DVY +13.77% / SPY +10.80%

Growth +19.85% vs IUSG +12.39%